

Prioritizing the factors Influencing Employer Attractiveness of Gen Z—An application of fuzzy analytic hierarchy process

Neelam Dhall* Disha Garg**

Abstract

The present study aims to explore the relative importance of the different dimensions of employer attractiveness on the job applicant's intention to join with special reference to Gen Z. Moreover, the study aims to provide suggestive measures for organizations to develop a comprehensive employer brand strategy that appeals to the multifaceted expectations of Gen Z.

Design/ methodology/ approach- The selected values of employer brand attractiveness were included in AHP questionnaire. Ninety-two management students studying in different management institutions were requested to provide their response and these were included for the prioritization using Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) method.

Findings- The research findings suggest that the most important perceived value of employer attractiveness was the Economic value carrying 31.85% importance, followed by Role value (16.85%), Psychological and Cultural value (12.72%), Career Growth value (12.54%) and Ease value (10.16%). The least important perceived values of employer attractiveness were found to be Employer Brand value (6.29%), Location value (5.77%) and Innovation value (3.82%).

Practical Implications- The results of the present study carry significant implications for organizations aiming to successfully attract talent, recognizing the importance of various values, including economic, role, psychological & cultural, career growth, ease, employer brand, location, and innovation, provides employers with actionable insights to customize their recruitment strategies. Moreover, the employer attractiveness perceived value index developed in the present study can be referred by organizations to gauge their respective employer attractiveness perceived value.

Keywords: Employer Attractiveness, Gen Z, Analytic Hierarchy Process

* Professor, Jagan Institute of Management Studies, 3 Institutional Area, Sector-5, Rohini, New Delhi-110085

** Assistant Professor, Institute of Information Technology & Management, Delhi

1. INTRODUCTION

Employer branding is an organization's image or impression as an employer to current and prospective employees. It encompasses associations such as the brand idea, values, and culture. A strong employer brand helps companies stand out in the job market, attracting candidates whose values and work styles align with the company's. It can also reduce hiring costs and employee turnover. Employer branding showcases the organization as a desirable workplace and offers an opportunity to secure employees who will lead the company into the future and support its business strategy (Soomro *et. al.*, 2018). In today's dynamic and competitive labor market, attracting and retaining top talent presents an increasingly daunting challenge for organizations spanning diverse industries. To confront this challenge head-on, companies are increasingly resorting to strategies aimed at bolstering their appeal to potential employees. Among these strategies, two critical concepts have emerged as linchpins in shaping organizations' efficacy in talent acquisition and retention: employer attractiveness and employer branding (Raj, 2021). As per Deloitte's 2024 Gen Z and Millennial Survey, Gen Z and millennials are increasingly rejecting employers that do not align with their values. Half of Gen Z and 43% of millennials have refused assignments due to personal ethics or beliefs, while 44% of Gen Z and 40% of millennials have turned down employers for similar reasons. Common factors for rejection include negative environmental impact, non-inclusive practices, and lack of support for mental well-being and work/life balance. Employer attractiveness pertains to the overall allure of an organization as an employer in the eyes of both current and prospective employees, encapsulating factors such as reputation, workplace culture, benefits, career development opportunities, and work-life balance initiatives. Given the intensifying competition for talent and the evolving expectations of today's workforce, comprehending the intricacies of employer attractiveness and branding is imperative for organizations striving to gain a competitive edge. Keeping this in mind, the present study aims to explore the relative importance of different dimensions of employer attractiveness based on the job applicant's intention to join with special reference to Gen Z. By analyzing these dimensions, the study aims to provide a comprehensive understanding of the values that make employers attractive to potential employees and offer a quantifiable measure of these perceptions across different firms. Through an exploration of these factors, this research aims to contribute to the existing body of knowledge on employer attractiveness and branding, ultimately aiding

organizations in their pursuit of sourcing talented workforce. The paper is organized into several sections: Section 2 contains the literature review, Section 3 covers the research methodology, Section 4 presents the data analysis, and Sections 5 and 6 include the discussion and conclusion.

2. Literature Review

Employer Branding

The notion of Employer Branding (EB) was originally introduced by Ambler & Barrow (1996), who defined it as the combination of functional, economic, and psychological benefits associated with employment, specifically tied to the hiring organization. Employer branding is commonly understood as the concerted efforts of a company to communicate its appeal as an attractive workplace to both current and potential employees (Lloyd, 2002). Studies have shown that companies with strong employer brands may reduce employee acquisition costs, improve employee relations, boost retention rates, and even offer lower salaries compared to organizations with weaker employer brands (Ritson, 2002).

Perceived Employer Attractiveness

Perceived employer attractiveness (PEA) refers to the anticipated benefits that potential employees associate with considering employment opportunities within an organization (Berthon *et al.*, 2005). Forming impressions about potential employers, including perceptions of organizational appeal, plays a crucial role in effectively attracting job applicants (Carless, 2007). Altmann & Suess (2015) suggest that employer attractiveness encompasses two interconnected dimensions: general appeal, which pertains to an individual's emotional perceptions and attitudes towards the company as a potential employer, and the active pursuit of job opportunities with the company (Reis *et al.*, 2021; Cable & Turban, 2001).

The eight major brand attributes namely (innovation value, psychological and cultural value, economic value, role value, employer brand value, career growth value, ease value and location value) were selected in the study. These eight selected values of employer brand attractiveness are further measured with the help of different dimensions/factors. The relative importance of the selected brand attributes with respect to their impact on the job applicants' intention to join is estimated. The selected brand attributes have been explained below:

Career growth value- "Career growth value" refers to the perceived

opportunities for professional advancement and development that a company offers its employees.

Ease Value- “Ease value” pertains to the convenience and flexibility that organizations offer their employees in terms of work arrangements.

Employer Brand Value- Employer brand value refers to the overall perception an employer holds in the eyes of employees and potential candidates. This concept hinges on positive employer characteristics, including a supportive work culture, leadership quality, competitive compensation, and commitment to employee development.

Economic Value- “Economic value” refers to the perceived worth and appeal of an organization based on its compensation and benefits package.

Employer Attractiveness- “Employer attractiveness” refers to the overall desirability of an organization as a place of employment in the eyes of current employees, potential candidates, and the broader job market.

Innovation Value- “Innovative value” pertains to the perception that an organization is forward-thinking and committed to innovation in its products and services.

Locational Value- “Locational value” refers to the significance of the geographical location of an organization as a factor influencing its appeal to potential candidates. This aspect takes into account the desirability of the location, especially if it aligns with the preferences or convenience of the workforce.

Psychological & Cultural Value- “Psychological and Cultural Value” refers to the intangible aspects of an organization’s environment that impact employees’ mental well-being and sense of belonging.

Role Value- “Role value” pertains to the perceived significance and empowerment associated with the roles offered by an organization.

Research Gap

Preferences of Generation Z represent a departure from traditional job priorities and suggest a movement towards a more holistic approach to work. Despite this shift in candidate expectations, research using the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) to analyze these changes remains scarce. AHP, a decision-making framework that ranks and prioritizes factors, could provide valuable insights into the complexities of candidate preferences. A more extensive application of AHP in this area could help employers better understand and respond to the changing job market dynamics, thereby aligning their offerings with the needs of Generation Z.

3. RESEARCH OBJECTIVES & METHODOLOGY

Research Objectives

1. To identify the relative importance of various dimensions of employer attractiveness based on the job applicant's intention to join with special reference to Gen Z.
2. To provide suggestive measures for organizations to develop a comprehensive employer brand strategy that appeals to the multifaceted expectations of Gen Z.

Research Methodology

The selected values of employer attractiveness were included in the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) questionnaire. Ninety-two management students studying in different management institutions were requested to provide their response against the pairwise comparison of the different selected values of employer attractiveness. The Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) is the most preferred fuzzy logic methods used to estimate the priorities/importance for the given attributes from the expert's perception. To apply Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) method the selected management students were requested to provide their responses towards values of employer attractiveness and participate in the survey. These management students were requested to use 1-to-9-point scale in providing the responses in the questionnaire.

4. DATA ANALYSIS

In the study, efforts have been made to identify the relative importance of the employer attractiveness values by the job applicant's intention to join. The different employer brand attributes were found on the basis of literature review. The various employer brand attributes were identified and selected in the context of management students completing their post graduate degree. The eight major brand attributes namely (*innovation value, psychological and cultural value, economic value, role value, employer brand value, career growth value, ease value and location value*) were selected to analyze their relative importance by the job applicants' intention to join. These eight selected values of employer brand attractiveness are further measured with the help of different items. These factors in total represents eight values of employer attractiveness, included for the prioritization using Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) method on the basis of responses received from the selected management students. The complete list of the values of employer brand attractiveness along with their items has been provided in Table-I:

Table I: List of employer attractiveness values and the corresponding Items

Employer Attractiveness Perceived Values	Items	Employer Attractiveness Perceived Values	Items
Innovation Value	Innovative products/services	Psychological and Cultural Value	Exciting work environment/work culture
	Novel work practices		High self esteem
	Prospective mindset and forward thinking		Sense of belongingness
	Innovation by the employees		Good interpersonal relationships with colleagues
	Continuously innovating		Supportive and encouraging colleagues at work
Economic Value	Attractive compensation package	Location Value	Location choices
	Good financial growth rate		Location near my home town
	Performance based incentives		Located in metropolitan cities
	Employee stock option plans		Compensation for relocation
	Attractive joining bonus.		Rent allowances
	Attractive pay revision	Employer Brand Value	High ranking in various Employer Brand Surveys
Role Value	Challenging/ interesting role		Good reputation in the market
	Highly involved in the job role		High online (social media) presence
	Valued/recognized in the job role		Low attrition rate
	Sense of achievement		Good word of mouth reputation
	Empowered in my job role		
	Sense of responsibility		
Career Growth Value	Career enhancement and development	Ease Value	Flexible working hours
	Sabbatical/ Financial assistance for higher studies		Work from home
	Good promotion opportunity		Work-life balance
	Skill development programmes		Transport facilities to commute
	Learning programs/projects for knowledge enhancement		Benefits while working from home

The results reported in table II & III represents the *most important* perceived value of employer brand attractiveness is *economic value* carrying 31.85 percent importance, followed by *role value* with 16.85 percent weight. The importance of economic constraints over role value when someone applies for a job can vary based on individual circumstances and priorities. Economic constraints, such as salary requirements, financial stability, and benefits, may take precedence in certain situations. For individuals facing immediate financial needs or prioritizing short-term economic goals, the compensation offered by a job becomes a primary consideration. Additionally, in industries with high competition for talent or when navigating economic uncertainties, salary and economic benefits may play a more crucial role in attracting candidates. The other important perceived values of employer brand attractiveness are *Psychological and Cultural Value* (12.72%), *Career Growth Value* (12.54%) and *Ease Value* (10.16%). Candidates prioritize Psychological and Cultural Value, Career Growth Value, and Ease Value when applying for a job due to their significant impact on overall job satisfaction and professional fulfillment. A positive workplace culture that aligns with individual values fosters a sense of belonging and mental well-being. Career growth opportunities, including skill development and advancement, appeal to individuals with long-term aspirations. Additionally, the ease of managing work responsibilities, encompassing factors like flexibility and a supportive work environment, contributes to job satisfaction and a positive overall experience. These values collectively guide candidates in making informed decisions about their career choices, while organizations that prioritize these aspects attract and retain top talent, fostering a productive and positive workplace. The least important perceived values of employer brand attractiveness are found to be *Employer Brand Value* (6.29%), *Location Value* (5.77%) and *Innovation Value* (3.82%). The importance of Employer Brand Value, Location Value, and Innovation Value for candidates applying for a job varies based on individual preferences and circumstances. While these factors may be less crucial in certain scenarios, they can play significant roles in shaping the overall job experience. Some candidates may prioritize specific job attributes, career growth, or personal values over the broader reputation of the employer, diminishing the perceived importance of Employer Brand Value. The relative importance of these values are also represented through graph in figure 2 & 3.

Table II: Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) input matrix

Faktor	Subfaktor	Strategic Performance Indicators										Operational Efficiency Metrics										Customer Satisfaction & Loyalty										Financial Health & Growth										Environmental & Social Responsibility										Innovation & Future Outlook																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																																				
		Revenue Growth	Profit Margin	Market Share	Customer Retention	Product Quality	Production Cost	Inventory Turn	Logistics Efficiency	Employee Productivity	Quality Control	Compliance	Customer Satisfaction	Net Promoter Score	Churn Rate	Repeat Purchase	Customer Lifetime Value	Brand Equity	Revenue	Profit	Assets	Liabilities	Equity	Debt-to-Equity Ratio	Return on Investment	Return on Assets	Return on Equity	Operating Margin	Net Income	EPS	Dividend Yield	ESG Score	Carbon Footprint	Waste Reduction	Employee Diversity	Community Engagement	R&D Spend	Patent Filings	New Product Launches	Market Penetration	Global Expansion	Partnerships	Acquisitions	Disposals	Restructuring	Share Repurchases	Debt Refinancing	ESG Initiatives	Climate Change	Social Impact	Governance	Transparency	Stakeholder Engagement	Regulatory Compliance	Legal Risks	Reputation Management	Crisis Response	Business Continuity	Disaster Preparedness	Insurance Coverage	Asset Protection	IT Security	Data Privacy	AI Adoption	Blockchain Integration	IoT Implementation	Cloud Migration	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics	AR/VR	Metaverse	Web3	Blockchain	AI	IoT	Cloud	Automation	Robotics

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Table III: Relative importance of the employer brand attractiveness values

<i>Employer Attractiveness Perceived Values</i>	<i>Local weight (Ranking)</i>	<i>Items</i>	<i>Global weight (Ranking)</i>	<i>Local weight (Ranking)</i>
Innovation Value	3.82%	Innovative products/services	0.70%	18.23%
		Novel work practices	0.75%	19.61%
		Prospective mindset and forward thinking	0.78%	20.35%
		Innovation by the employees	0.89%	23.24%
		Continuously innovating	0.71%	18.56%
Psychological and Cultural Value	12.72%	Exciting work environment/work culture	2.72%	21.41%
		High self esteem	2.85%	22.39%
		Sense of belongingness	2.55%	20.03%
		Good interpersonal relationships with colleagues	2.47%	19.43%
		Supportive and encouraging colleagues at work	2.13%	16.73%
Economic Value	31.85%	Attractive compensation package	6.37%	20.01%
		Good financial growth rate	6.16%	19.33%
		Performance based incentives	5.42%	17.03%
		Employee stock option plans	3.95%	12.41%
		Attractive joining bonus.	4.53%	14.23%
		Attractive pay revision	5.41%	17.00%
Role Value	16.85%	Challenging/interesting role	3.15%	18.67%
		Highly involved in the job role	3.02%	17.90%
		Valued/recognized in the job role	2.94%	17.47%
		Sense of achievement	2.72%	16.12%
		Empowered in my job role	2.61%	15.50%
		Sense of responsibility	2.42%	14.34%
Employer Brand Value	6.29%	High ranking in various Employer Brand Surveys	1.73%	27.45%
		Good reputation in the market	1.65%	26.19%
		High online (social media) presence	0.67%	10.58%
		Low attrition rate	0.56%	8.85%
		Good word of mouth reputation	1.69%	26.93%

Career Growth Value	12.54%	Career enhancement and development	2.91%	23.21%
		Sabbatical/ Financial assistance for higher studies	1.68%	13.36%
		Good promotion opportunity	3.44%	27.41%
		Skill development programmes	2.45%	19.57%
		Learning programs/projects for knowledge enhancement	2.06%	16.46%
Ease Value	10.16%	Flexible working hours	1.62%	16.00%
		Work from home	1.00%	9.88%
		Work-life balance	5.09%	50.08%
		Transport facilities to commute	1.30%	12.85%
		Benefits while working from home	1.14%	11.19%
	5.77%	Location choices	0.94%	16.37%
		Location near my home town	1.71%	29.61%
		Located in metropolitan cities	0.90%	15.65%
		Compensation for relocation	1.17%	20.20%
		Rent allowances	1.05%	18.17%

Economic value: The economic value is found to be the *most important* perceived values of employer brand attractiveness from applicant perspective. The economic value has six items *namely attractive compensation package, good financial growth rate, performance-based incentives, employee stock option plans, attractive joining bonus and attractive pay revision*. The local as well as global ranking of these items are estimated. The results reported that attractive compensation package (local ranking=20.1%) is the most important item since it attracts the most to the job applicants. The other important items representing economic value is good financial growth rate (local ranking = 19.33%) as every job applicant expects a good growth rate after joining the job. This is followed by *performance-based incentives* (local ranking=17.03%) and *attractive pay revision* (local ranking=17%). The least important items of economic value are found to be *attractive joining bonus* (local ranking=14.23%) and *ESOPs* (local ranking=12.41%).

Role value: The next most important employer attractiveness value is found to be role value which is represented by six items *namely challenging/ interesting role, highly involved in the job role, valued/recognized in the job role, sense of achievement, empowered in my job role and sense of responsibility*. The most important item representing role value is found

to be challenging/ interesting role (*local ranking* = 18.67%). Every job applicant expects interesting role in the firm which is the most motivating item also for the job applicant. The next most important item of role value is high involvement in job role (*local ranking* = 17.90%). Every job applicant requires high involvement with their jobs. The job applicant also expect recognition in their job role (*local ranking* = 17.47%) and high sense of achievement (16.12%). The least found important items representing role value are *Empowered in job role* (*local ranking* = 15.50%) and *sense of responsibility* (*local ranking*=14.34%).

Psychological and Cultural Value: The third important employer attractiveness value is found to be psychological and cultural value which is represented by five items namely *exciting work environment/ work culture, high self esteem, sense of belongingness, good interpersonal relationships with colleagues and supportive and encouraging colleagues at work*. The most important item representing psychological and cultural value is found to be High self esteem (*local ranking* = 22.39%). Every job applicant expects high self-esteem in the firm which is the most motivating factor also for the job applicant. The next most important item of psychological and cultural value is Exciting work environment/ work culture (*local ranking* = 21.41%). Every job applicant requires exciting work environment/ work culture. The job applicant also expect sense of belongingness (*local ranking* = 20.03%) and Good interpersonal relationships with colleagues (19.43%). The least found important value representing psychological and cultural value is Supportive and encouraging colleagues at work (*local ranking*=16.73%).

Career Growth Value: The next important value is found to be career growth value which is represented by five items namely *career enhancement and development, sabbatical/ financial assistance for higher studies, good promotion opportunity, skill development programmes and learning programs/projects for knowledge enhancement*. The most important item representing is found to be Good promotion opportunity (*local ranking* = 27.41%). Every job applicant expects good promotion opportunity in the firm which is the most motivating factor also for the job applicant. The next most important item of career growth value is Career enhancement and development (*local ranking* = 23.21%). Every job applicant requires career enhancement and development. The job applicant also expect skill development programmes (*local ranking* = 19.57%) and learning programs/projects for knowledge enhancement (16.46%). The least found important value representing career growth value is sabbatical/ financial assistance for higher studies (*local ranking*=13.36%).

Ease Value: The less significant value after career growth value is ease value which is represented by five items namely *flexible working hours, work from home, work-life balance, transport facilities to commute and benefits while working from home*. The most important item representing is found to be work-life balance (*local ranking = 50.08%*). Every job applicant expects work-life balance in the firm which is the most motivating factor also for the job applicant. The next most important factor of ease value is flexible working hours (*local ranking = 16.00%*). Every job applicant requires flexible working hours. The job applicant also expect transport facilities to commute (*local ranking = 12.85%*) and benefits while working from home (*11.19%*). The least found important value representing ease value is work from home (*local ranking=9.88%*).

Employer Brand Value: The less significant value after ease value is employer brand value which is represented by four factors namely *high ranking in various employer brand surveys, good reputation in the market, high online (social media) presence and low attrition rate*. The most important item representing is found to be high ranking in various Employer Brand Surveys (*local ranking = 27.45%*). Every job applicant expects high ranking of the firm in various Employer Brand Surveys which is the most motivating item also for the job applicant. The next most important item of employer brand value is good reputation in the market (*local ranking = 26.19%*). Every job applicant wants to work in the firm which has good reputation in the market. The job applicant also expect high online (social media) presence (*local ranking = 10.58%*). The least found important value representing employer brand value is low attrition rate (*local ranking=8.85%*).

Location Value: One of the least significant value is location value which is represented by five factors namely *location choices, location near my home town, located in metropolitan cities, compensation for relocation and rent allowances*. The most important item representing is found to be Location near my home town (*local ranking = 29.61%*). Every job applicant expects nearby firm location to his hometown which is the most motivating factor also for the job applicant. The next most important item of location value is compensation for relocation (*local ranking = 20.20%*). Every job applicant requires compensation for relocation. The job applicant also expect rent allowances (*local ranking = 18.17%*) and location choices (*16.37%*). The least found important value representing location value is located in metropolitan cities (*local ranking=15.65%*).

Innovation Value: The least significant value is found to be innovation value which is represented by five items namely *innovative*

products/services, novel work practices, prospective mindset and forward thinking, innovation by the employees and continuously innovating. The most important item representing is found to be Innovation by the employees (*local ranking* = 23.24%). Every job applicant expects that the firm should promote innovation by the employees which is the most motivating item also for the job applicant. The next most important item of innovation value is prospective mindset and forward thinking (*local ranking* = 20.35%). Every job applicant requires a firm which has prospective mindset and forward thinking. The job applicant also expect novel work practices (*local ranking* = 19.61%) and a firm which is continuously innovating (18.56%). The least found important value representing innovation value is innovative products/services (*local ranking*=18.23%).

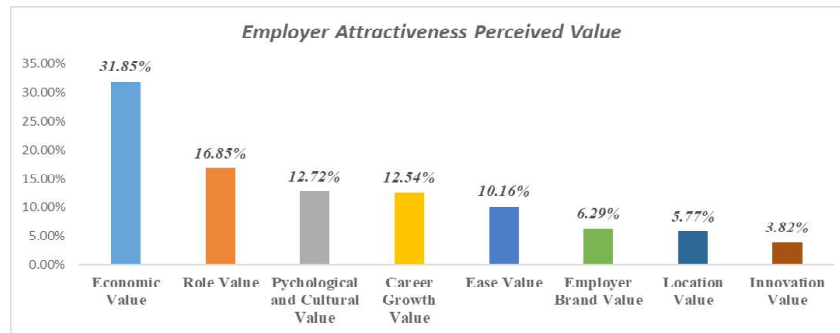


Fig. 1: Employer Attractiveness Perceived Values graph based on relative importance

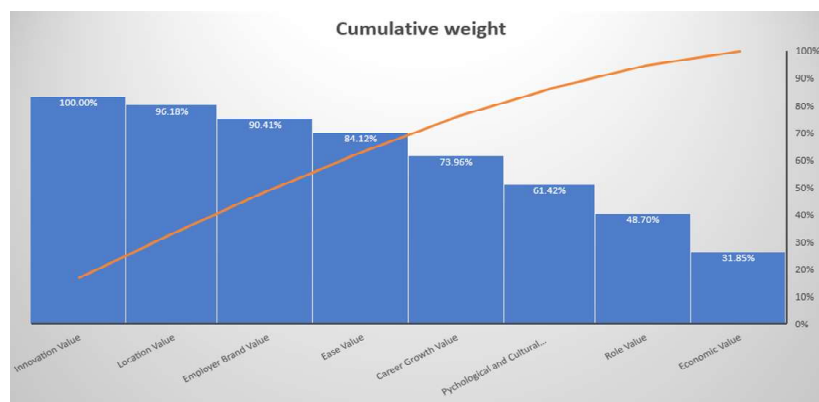


Fig. 2: Employer Attractiveness Perceived Values cumulative weight graph based on relative importance

Employer attractiveness perceived value (EAPV) Index

Further, based on the result findings, an effort has been made to develop the index measuring the employer attractiveness value. The index is developed on the basis of relative weights estimated from the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) method. The firms can estimate their Employer attractiveness perceived value on the basis of this index. The EAPV index can be calculated as per the details shared below:

$$\text{EAPV} = \text{Economic value} * 31.85\% + \text{Role value} * 16.85\% + \text{Psychological and cultural value} * 12.72\% + \text{Career growth value} * 12.54\% + \text{Ease value} * 10.16\% + \text{Employer brand value} * 6.29\% + \text{Location value} * 5.77\% + \text{Innovation value} * 3.82\%$$

5. DISCUSSION

The results of the present study carry significant implications for organizations aiming to successfully attract talent. In a practical sense, recognizing the relative importance of the various employer attractiveness dimensions, including economic, role, psychological, cultural, career growth, ease, employer brand, location, and innovation, provides employers with actionable insights to customize their recruitment strategies. Additionally, insights into the significance of factors such as location preferences and innovation initiatives enable organizations to align their offerings with the preferences and expectations of prospective talent, thereby increasing their competitiveness in the labor market. The research outlines various employer attractiveness values that influence job applicants' decisions when evaluating potential employers. Economic value, particularly an attractive compensation package and good financial growth rate, is the most important factor for job seekers. Role value, characterized by challenging and interesting job roles, is also crucial. Psychological and cultural value, such as high self-esteem and an exciting work environment, play a significant role in attracting candidates. Career growth value, including good promotion opportunities, is vital for applicants seeking development and progression. Ease value emphasizes work-life balance and flexible working hours, while employer brand value prioritizes high rankings in employer brand surveys and good market reputation. Location value considers proximity to the applicant's hometown and relocation compensation. Innovation value, while less significant, focuses on promoting innovation by employees and prospective thinking. Overall, these values guide organizations in understanding and meeting the expectations of potential job applicants.

Organizations can use the employer attractiveness perceived value Index developed in the present study to gauge their Employer attractiveness perceived value. The employer attractiveness value index is an essential tool for organizations to gauge their appeal to potential candidates in the job market. This index, developed using the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) method, allows firms to understand how they are perceived in terms of desirability as an employer. It offers insights into an organization's strengths and areas needing improvement, guiding recruitment strategies to align with candidate preferences such as benefits, career growth, and work culture.

From a theoretical perspective, these findings contribute to the broader understanding of the multifaceted nature of employer attractiveness and shed light on the underlying factors that influence the perceptions and preferences of Gen Z when considering job opportunities. By elucidating the relative importance of different values within the context of employer attractiveness, this research enhances our understanding of the complex dynamics involved in talent attraction.

6. CONCLUSION

In conclusion, the study highlights the various employer attractiveness values that significantly influence preferences of Gen Z job seekers. By understanding and aligning with these diverse values, organizations can create a comprehensive employer brand strategy that appeals to the multifaceted expectations of this cohort. This strategic approach not only enhances an employer's competitiveness in attracting top talent but also supports the long-term sustainability of the organization. The present study indicates the necessity for organizations to undertake employer branding initiatives in light of the increasingly competitive landscape of the contemporary labor market, where attracting and retaining top talent has become paramount for organizational success. In today's fiercely competitive job market, where talented professionals have numerous options available to them, a strong employer brand serves as a powerful magnet for attracting and retaining top talent. It goes beyond just offering competitive salaries and benefits; it encompasses the organization's values, culture, workplace environment, and reputation as an employer. When companies invest time and resources into understanding and refining their employer brand attributes, they create a compelling narrative that resonates with prospective employees.

This paper introduces a novel conceptual integration of the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP) within Multi-Criteria Decision-Making (MCDM) frameworks specifically tailored for strategic decision-making contexts. Unlike previous studies that apply AHP in isolation or within narrow domains, this paper bridges the gap between theoretical foundations and practical implementation by offering a structured yet adaptable model that emphasizes stakeholder engagement, transparency, and consistency. The framework not only enhances decision accuracy but also serves as a replicable guideline across industries, contributing significantly to both academic literature and managerial practice.

From an academic standpoint, the model contributes to decision sciences by integrating hierarchical analysis with strategic decision-making principles. It opens avenues for empirical validation and cross-sectoral applications, especially in domains such as healthcare, sustainability, defense, and policy development where decision complexity is high. Furthermore, it encourages the incorporation of stakeholder perspectives at different levels of the decision hierarchy, thereby aligning strategic outcomes with organizational values and long-term objectives.

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